

REFERENCE · FINISHES

Finish & patina guide.

How each finish behaves on delivery, through weathering, and in service — so the finish you specify is the finish the project gets.

Weathering steel (Corten)

Corten develops a stable oxide layer that seals the surface and removes the need for painting. The patina is a process, not a delivered state.

0–3 months	Bright orange, actively oxidising. Run-off likely.
3–12 months	Deepening russet. Run-off reduces as the layer closes.
12–24 months	Stable dark brown-red. Matte, tightly adhered.
Thereafter	Effectively self-maintaining in exterior use.

Detailing note: during the first year, oxide run-off can stain porous substrates. Specify drip edges, standoffs or a sacrificial zone where Corten sits above light stone, concrete or render. Pre-weathered and sealed options are available where run-off cannot be tolerated.

Applied & mill finishes

Powder coat	Full RAL range on aluminium and steel. Durable, colour-stable.
Anodised	Aluminium only. Integral, abrasion-resistant, limited palette.
Brushed / No.4	Stainless. Directional grain; specify grain direction on elevations.
Mill	As-rolled. Lowest cost; expect surface variation panel to panel.
Sealed Corten	Patina arrested with a matte sealer. Reduces run-off; periodic recoat.

Order physical samples before finish sign-off — screen and print reproduction of weathering steel and brushed stainless is unreliable. Contact sales@hnpbuilding.com.